

Subject Code	AF5943
Subject Title	Research Project in Applied Economics
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Normal Duration	One Semester
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Microeconomics <i>OR</i> Macroeconomics
Objectives	This course provides student with an opportunity to, under the supervision of a qualified academic staff, conduct an independent research project in Economics. The research project topic is usually proposed by the student and subject to the assessment and approval by the individual supervisor. The practical application of knowledge and skills ensures that students are well-prepared to tackle challenges in business, economics, finance, and policy, which facilitates Program Learning Outcome 3 .
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a. formulate theoretically grounded research questions. b. exhibit skills essential to the planning and conduct of rigorous research.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	Students work under the guidance of the academic supervisor on a mutually agreed research topic. Regular supervision will be provided by the subject leader and assigned supervisor(s) throughout the semester. Subject contents depend on the area and nature of project. <i>Project Proposal</i> Students should choose a research topic in applied economics. Project proposal should be submitted in week 5 and approved by the subject leader/supervisor. The proposal should constitute a firm plan of work and should clearly identify the problem or issue to be investigated, along with a clear methodology for the project. The project topic should be within the scope of the award and has a clear problem-solving focus. <i>Project Report</i> Submitted at the end of the semester (normally week 13). The report should normally be around 6,000 words (including tables, charts, references and appendix if any). Project reports will be assessed according to the importance of the research question, the grasp of prior knowledge and research in the field, the argument developed by the student, the methodological issues in data gathering and analysis, the policy recommendations drawn upon the research findings, as well as the quality of the writing.
Teaching/Learning Methodology	This subject will be taught in both lecture and seminar formats. Individual performance is assessed by a student's specific role in her/his study group, including presentation, comments, Q&A, and written report. Students are expected to self-study outside of class time by completing assigned readings and solving practice problems.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)					
			a	b				
	1. Project proposal	30%	✓	✓				
	2. Project report	70%	✓	✓				
	Total	100 %						
	<i>Note: The minimum passing grade of this subject is D. The specific requirements on individual assessment components discussed above could be adjusted based on the pedagogical needs of subject lecturers.</i>							
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:							
	▪ Regular meetings with the supervisor				13 Hrs.			
	Other student study effort:							
	▪ On average students are expected to spend around 8 more hours each week for reading the relevant academic and professional materials, information gathering, data collection, model construction, and writing the project proposal and report.				104 Hrs.			
	Total student study effort				117 Hrs.			

Reading List and References	Depend on the project area and nature.
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